



# Discussion Guide: Danté Stewart

## The Power of Self-Reinvention

### Reflect

- Describe a moment in your life in which you pursued a goal because of someone else's expectations for you. Do you regret doing so? Why or why not?
- Read 1 Samuel 9-10. How did Saul's upbringing shape the way he saw himself? How did he reinvent himself after receiving God's message for him through the prophet Samuel?
- Danté says that the most courageous thing one can do is to leave some things behind. Have you ever had to leave something behind in order to become more fully yourself? What was that experience like? What kind of change did it allow for in your life?

### Respond

- In *The Fire Next Time*, James Baldwin begins with a letter to his nephew on the 100th anniversary of emancipation. In it, he writes, "The details and symbols of your life have been deliberately constructed to make you believe what white people say about you.... it was intended that you should perish in the ghetto, perish by never being allowed to go behind the white man's definitions, by never being allowed to spell your proper name. You have, and many of us have, defeated this intention." In what ways have you had to resist what others say about you? In what ways did this help you reclaim a sense of power and agency in your life?
- Danté concludes his talk by challenging his listeners to trust themselves and bet on themselves. What would it look like in your life to trust yourself right now? What cards have you been dealt that you need to bet on?